Sample solution

Parent–teacher conference appointment letters

Organisation: Palmetto Point Secondary School
Portfolio element: Mail Merge – (a) Primary Document (b) Data Source (c) Final Merged Documents
Scenario: merge-1

Model answer · Teacher's Version

How this meets the marking criteria

Criterion	Marks	Where it is met in this solution
Data source: all 9 field names present and spelt as given (Title, FirstName, LastName, Address1, District, StudentName, Form, ApptTime, Room)	**2**	Data Source (p. 3): row 1 of worksheet Parents holds the 9 field names exactly as given – Title, FirstName, LastName, Address1, District, StudentName, Form, ApptTime, Room – with no spaces inside a name.
Data source: all 7 records entered completely and accurately	**2**	Data Source (p. 3): rows 2–8 hold all 7 records, keyed as shown in (b) (accents, "Mr and Mrs", currency symbols and commas kept as text so they merge unchanged).
Data source saved and labelled correctly as PTC Parents Data	**1**	Saved as **PTC Parents Data.xlsx**; the printout carries the header "Data Source: PTC Parents Data" and the footer label "Data Source" with the candidate's name.
Primary document: date (2 November 2026) correctly placed	**1**	Primary Document (p. 2): the date is keyed at the left margin one blank line below the letterhead, with no punctuation (open punctuation).
Primary document: inside address built from merge fields («Title» «FirstName» «LastName», «Address1», «District», Barbados)	**1**	Primary Document (p. 2): inside address lines are real MERGEFIELD codes – «Title» «FirstName» «LastName», «Address1», «District», Barbados – one item per line, no end punctuation.
Primary document: salutation with merge fields (Dear «Title» «LastName»)	**1**	Primary Document (p. 2): "Dear «Title» «LastName»" with one space between the fields and no comma; merged, it reads e.g. "Dear Mrs Alleyne".
Primary document: body complete with merge fields «StudentName» (twice), «Form», «ApptTime» and «Room» in the correct places	**1**	Primary Document (p. 2): the subject heading and body paragraphs are keyed in full with «StudentName» (2×), «Form», «ApptTime», «Room» placed exactly as in (a); one blank line between paragraphs (block style).
Primary document: closing complete (Yours sincerely, signature space, Mrs Valerie Duncan, Head of Year 3)	**1**	Primary Document (p. 2): "Yours sincerely" (no comma), a four-line signature space, then the name and designation.
Final merged document: 7 letters, one per record, each starting on a new page	**1**	Merged Documents (pp. 4–10): 7 letters, one per record in data-source order; each letter starts on a new page and fits on one A4 page.
Final merged document consistent with the data source: every letter shows its own record's data in every field (for example, Dr Marisol Peña – Diego Peña – 3A – 5:00 p.m. – Room 14)	**1**	Merged Documents (pp. 4–10): every field on every page was checked against its own record (automated text comparison of the printout) – Dr Marisol Peña – Diego Peña – 3A – 5:00 p.m. – Room 14 included.
Mailable merged letters (guidelines a, d, f): no doubled or missing spaces or punctuation around merge fields, no typographical errors	**1**	Single spaces between fields on the same line, no space before 's, punctuation kept round fields; spelling and figures proofread – every letter is mailable.
Total	**13**	**Every criterion is met in full.**

Files in this pack: merge-1 - Sample solution.pdf; Primary letter – PTC.docx; PTC Parents Data.xlsx; Merged letters – PTC.docx.

The data source is supplied as an Excel workbook (Word's Type a New List saves an Access .mdb file); to run the merge again, open the primary letter and choose Mailings › Select Recipients › Use an Existing List.

PALMETTO POINT SECONDARY SCHOOL
12 Hill Road, Speightstown, Barbados
Telephone: +1 (246) 422 7710 · E-mail: office@palmettopoint.edu.bb

2 November 2026

«Title» «FirstName» «LastName»
«Address1»
«District»
Barbados

Dear «Title» «LastName»

PARENT–TEACHER CONFERENCE – TERM 1, 2026

The Form 3 Parent–Teacher Conference will be held on Thursday, 12 November 2026 at the school. We have reserved an appointment for you to discuss the Term 1 progress report of «StudentName» of Form «Form».

Your appointment is at «ApptTime» in Room «Room» with the Form Teacher. Each appointment lasts 15 minutes, so please arrive five minutes early. If you are unable to attend, kindly call the school office on +1 (246) 422 7710 so that another time can be arranged.

We look forward to meeting you and to working together for «StudentName»’s success.

Yours sincerely

Mrs Valerie Duncan
Head of Year 3

Data Source: PTC Parents Data (worksheet Parents)

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
1	**Title**	**FirstName**	**LastName**	**Address1**	**District**	**StudentName**	**Form**	**ApptTime**	**Room**
2	Mrs	Andrea	Alleyne	22 Hibiscus Drive	Speightstown	Jalen Alleyne	3B	4:00 p.m.	12
3	Mr	Rudolph	Greaves	5 Seaview Lane	Mullins	Amara Greaves	3A	4:15 p.m.	14
4	Ms	Felicia	Trotman	17 Mahogany Street	Rock Hall	Tariq Trotman	3B	4:30 p.m.	12
5	Mr and Mrs	Leon	Brooks	41 Coral Way	Boscobelle	Shania Brooks	3C	4:45 p.m.	9
6	Dr	Marisol	Peña	3 Palm Court	Crab Hill	Diego Peña	3A	5:00 p.m.	14
7	Mrs	Joan	Hinds	60 Frangipani Road	Checker Hall	Kaylee Hinds	3C	5:15 p.m.	9
8	Mr	Winston	Lake	12 Church Street	Holetown	Jamal Lake	3B	5:30 p.m.	12

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2 November 2026

Mrs Andrea Alleyne
22 Hibiscus Drive
Speightstown
Barbados

Dear Mrs Alleyne

PARENT–TEACHER CONFERENCE – TERM 1, 2026

The Form 3 Parent–Teacher Conference will be held on Thursday, 12 November 2026 at the school. We have reserved an appointment for you to discuss the Term 1 progress report of Jalen Alleyne of Form 3B.

Your appointment is at 4:00 p.m. in Room 12 with the Form Teacher. Each appointment lasts 15 minutes, so please arrive five minutes early. If you are unable to attend, kindly call the school office on +1 (246) 422 7710 so that another time can be arranged.

We look forward to meeting you and to working together for Jalen Alleyne’s success.

Yours sincerely

Mrs Valerie Duncan
Head of Year 3

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2 November 2026

Mr Rudolph Greaves
5 Seaview Lane
Mullins
Barbados

Dear Mr Greaves

PARENT–TEACHER CONFERENCE – TERM 1, 2026

The Form 3 Parent–Teacher Conference will be held on Thursday, 12 November 2026 at the school. We have reserved an appointment for you to discuss the Term 1 progress report of Amara Greaves of Form 3A.

Your appointment is at 4:15 p.m. in Room 14 with the Form Teacher. Each appointment lasts 15 minutes, so please arrive five minutes early. If you are unable to attend, kindly call the school office on +1 (246) 422 7710 so that another time can be arranged.

We look forward to meeting you and to working together for Amara Greaves’s success.

Yours sincerely

Mrs Valerie Duncan
Head of Year 3

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2 November 2026

Ms Felicia Trotman
17 Mahogany Street
Rock Hall
Barbados

Dear Ms Trotman

PARENT–TEACHER CONFERENCE – TERM 1, 2026

The Form 3 Parent–Teacher Conference will be held on Thursday, 12 November 2026 at the school. We have reserved an appointment for you to discuss the Term 1 progress report of Tariq Trotman of Form 3B.

Your appointment is at 4:30 p.m. in Room 12 with the Form Teacher. Each appointment lasts 15 minutes, so please arrive five minutes early. If you are unable to attend, kindly call the school office on +1 (246) 422 7710 so that another time can be arranged.

We look forward to meeting you and to working together for Tariq Trotman’s success.

Yours sincerely

Mrs Valerie Duncan
Head of Year 3

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2 November 2026

Mr and Mrs Leon Brooks
41 Coral Way
Boscobelle
Barbados

Dear Mr and Mrs Brooks

PARENT–TEACHER CONFERENCE – TERM 1, 2026

The Form 3 Parent–Teacher Conference will be held on Thursday, 12 November 2026 at the school. We have reserved an appointment for you to discuss the Term 1 progress report of Shania Brooks of Form 3C.

Your appointment is at 4:45 p.m. in Room 9 with the Form Teacher. Each appointment lasts 15 minutes, so please arrive five minutes early. If you are unable to attend, kindly call the school office on +1 (246) 422 7710 so that another time can be arranged.

We look forward to meeting you and to working together for Shania Brooks’s success.

Yours sincerely

Mrs Valerie Duncan
Head of Year 3

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2 November 2026

Dr Marisol Peña
3 Palm Court
Crab Hill
Barbados

Dear Dr Peña

PARENT–TEACHER CONFERENCE – TERM 1, 2026

The Form 3 Parent–Teacher Conference will be held on Thursday, 12 November 2026 at the school. We have reserved an appointment for you to discuss the Term 1 progress report of Diego Peña of Form 3A.

Your appointment is at 5:00 p.m. in Room 14 with the Form Teacher. Each appointment lasts 15 minutes, so please arrive five minutes early. If you are unable to attend, kindly call the school office on +1 (246) 422 7710 so that another time can be arranged.

We look forward to meeting you and to working together for Diego Peña’s success.

Yours sincerely

Mrs Valerie Duncan
Head of Year 3

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2 November 2026

Mrs Joan Hinds
60 Frangipani Road
Checker Hall
Barbados

Dear Mrs Hinds

PARENT–TEACHER CONFERENCE – TERM 1, 2026

The Form 3 Parent–Teacher Conference will be held on Thursday, 12 November 2026 at the school. We have reserved an appointment for you to discuss the Term 1 progress report of Kaylee Hinds of Form 3C.

Your appointment is at 5:15 p.m. in Room 9 with the Form Teacher. Each appointment lasts 15 minutes, so please arrive five minutes early. If you are unable to attend, kindly call the school office on +1 (246) 422 7710 so that another time can be arranged.

We look forward to meeting you and to working together for Kaylee Hinds’s success.

Yours sincerely

Mrs Valerie Duncan
Head of Year 3

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2 November 2026

Mr Winston Lake
12 Church Street
Holetown
Barbados

Dear Mr Lake

PARENT–TEACHER CONFERENCE – TERM 1, 2026

The Form 3 Parent–Teacher Conference will be held on Thursday, 12 November 2026 at the school. We have reserved an appointment for you to discuss the Term 1 progress report of Jamal Lake of Form 3B.

Your appointment is at 5:30 p.m. in Room 12 with the Form Teacher. Each appointment lasts 15 minutes, so please arrive five minutes early. If you are unable to attend, kindly call the school office on +1 (246) 422 7710 so that another time can be arranged.

We look forward to meeting you and to working together for Jamal Lake’s success.

Yours sincerely

Mrs Valerie Duncan
Head of Year 3